

Beyond the financial planner and the money manager, I'd need a brokerage house to make the investments. Mr. Leffert said his firm worked closely with a discount broker that offered very competitive rates. As for an accountant, he said I could continue to use the one I had, or else I could employ one from M. H. Senzel.

That more or less ended our free introductory consultation. Mr. Leffert gave me a set of contracts to review and invited me to get back to him when I was ready for the data-gathering, but I never did. The prospect of having to pay the original planning fee, plus the cost of semiannual checkups—not to mention the money manager, the stockbroker, and possibly the accountant—was worrisome. I doubted there would be much money left to manage. As capable and as thoughtful as Mr. Leffert had been, I decided to move along without the benefit of his firm's considerable professionalism. Maybe I can save you the same trouble with this Fourth Useful Tip:

Financial security is too expensive for the average investor
